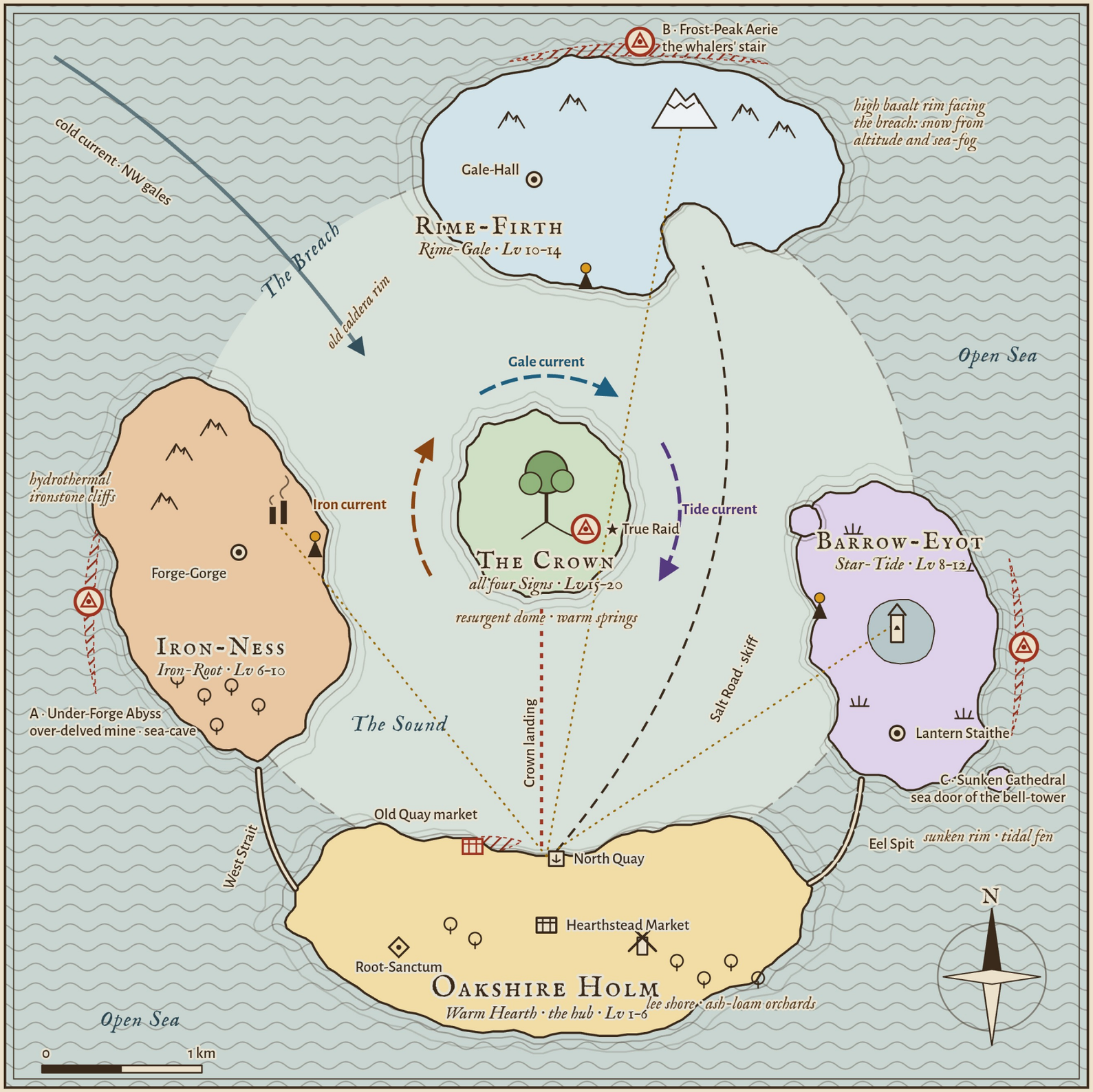
The Caldera Isles

5 grids · 4 seams · 4 world flags · 1 Ebb



Spine Hobb · **Geology** Tolkien · **Sightlines & shores** Le Guin · **Cut** Musk razor

Island	Lv	Sign · Calling	Landmark	Ebb bares
Oakshire S	1–6	Warm Hearth	windmill	Old Quay market
Iron-Ness W	6–10	Iron-Root · Shield-Sworn	forge stacks	A Under-Forge
Barrow-Eyot E	8–12	Star-Tide · Lantern-Bearers	bell-tower	C Cathedral
Rime-Firth N	10–14	Rime-Gale · Wayfarers	snow peak	B Aerie
The Crown C	15–20	all four	World-Tree	★ True Raid

The loop

1. **Lv 1–6.** Grow up in Oakshire; clear the Root-Sanctum. All three lanes go dark.
2. **Lv 6–14.** Walk the West Strait or Eel Spit, or ring the Salt Road bell. Any order works; need points Iron → Barrow → Rime.
3. **Light a beacon:** its lane reopens (a new stall at Hearthstead), its current at the Crown calms, its Sign is earned.
4. **Three beacons** open the Crown landing (Lv 15–20). Ring the Harmonic Bell.
5. **The Long Flood ends:** the sea falls 6 m. Raids A, B, C and the Old Quay market appear on maps you already know. Return to the Crown for the True Raid.

Legend

- Causeway (walk)
- Shingle spit (walk)
- Lantern-Skiff lane
- Crown landing · 3 beacons
- Current (calms per beacon)
- Bared at the Ebb (–6 m)
- Sealed raid gate
- Beacon (1 flag)
- Sightline from North Quay
- Breach current
- Market · Ebb market
- Steading · quay

Why it holds together

A volcano collapsed and the sea broke in from the north-west. The high rim facing the breach is cold; the low rim sank to fen; ironstone came up from the hot rock; the lee got the ash-loam and the people. The dome in the middle kept its warmth — and its tree.